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The Pixel has worked quite well for you. What is the future?

The unique value proposition we will offer is—anytime we make a computing device, you are bringing together an experience at the intersection of hardware, software and services. The Google approach will include AI, which is why we are building Google Tensor. It allows us to do a lot of powerful things like the camera, understand what music is playing around you and we will continue to see extensions of that.

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Much has been said about digital transformation. What does it mean to you?

It's extraordinary that the world, through the pandemic, was able to work so seamlessly. My dad said something interesting to me—if the pandemic had happened when he was working, it was impossible for him to imagine how it would have played out. In many ways, it shows the potential of what technology has made possible. Having said that, my view is that all this should augment interactions in the physical world and not be a substitute for it. One has seen it in the US, where there has been a clear setback in education and I am sure that's true around the world. Over time, we have to figure out how all of this works to make connections and also what we all experience as humanity and not necessarily be a substitute or be isolating. To me, there is more progress to be made. So far, what has been achieved is amazing and for countries like India, I see this as an opportunity because it is transforming digitally and you can almost transform to the future state. Mobile and data are good examples of it.



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There is a lot of discussion about a funding winter globally. With a decline in the valuations of tech stocks, things are getting even more complicated. What lies ahead?

While these are painful [times] to work through in the short term, history shows great companies are built even through these moments. Google too was in a similar state after the dotcom crash in 2000. Good companies will also get funding in tough times and it separates the signal from the noise. For an entrepreneur, there is no better time to build a company—it's easier to hire people and you learn to build it with a more frugal foundation. These are natural cycles and while the short term will be difficult, it will not change the long-term trajectory [of growth].

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There are new AI technologies like ChatGPT disrupting search, which is your core area. How is Google going to counter that?

[Taken from the transcript of an analysts' call on February 2, 2023] Now that we can integrate more direct LLM [large language models, an algorithm that can recognise, translate, summarise and predict content from data]-type experiences in Search, I think it will help us expand and serve new types of use cases. I see this as a chance to rethink and re-imagine and drive Search to solve more use cases for our users as well. So again, early days, you will see us be bold, put things out, get feedback and iterate and make things better. **BT**

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This interview was taken before Google announced the layoffs of 12,000 employees globally